CAREER GLITCH · SHORT · SIMPLE · NO BORING PARTS

INSURANCE CLAIMS ADJUSTER IN THE AI ERA

BLS's own outlook names the killer: software that reads your photos and prices the claim. The beginner's small claims are its first meal.

★ TL;DR — NO. The pay is real — BLS median $78,000 (May 2025) — but growth is −5% through 2035, all ~21,600 openings a year are replacements, and BLS says in plain text that technology and AI will automate the tasks. Beginners start on 'small claims, under supervision' — precisely the layer FNOL bots and photo-estimating already handle. The roadmap below is the way OUT: stay in insurance, move to the side that sells and manages risk instead of processing it. ★

THE CAREER GLITCH TAKE

OUR TAKE: NO — NOT IN 2027

MEDIAN ~$78K · TRAINING 1–6 months · AI RISK HIGH · CERTIFICATE

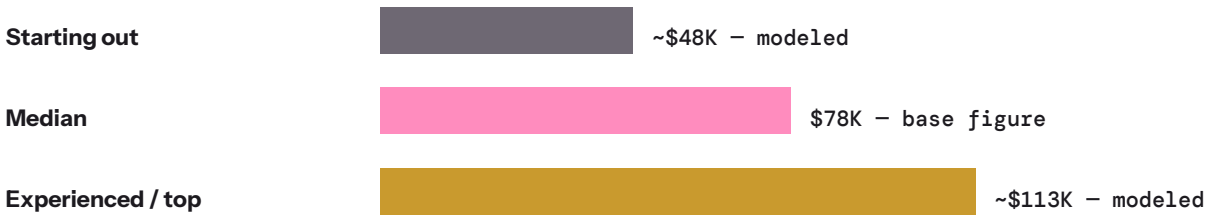
- Fails as a start because: the occupation shrinks −5% (−21,800 jobs in the wider group) while BLS names automation in its outlook text and WEF ranks claims adjusters #12-fastest-declining.

- The deployment problem: Lemonade's AI Jim takes first notice of loss with no human help 96% of the time and can run ~55% of claims start to finish; Tractable reports ~70% of cases handled without human involvement.

- Still worth money: insurance itself. Licensed producers sell policies and keep books of business; property managers run the buildings claims get filed on. The industry is fine — the processing rung is what's being removed.

The site's take, built from this profession's numbers in the Career Glitch base.

THE MONEY — LOOK AT THE BARS



The Career Glitch base figure for Insurance Claims Adjuster is a ~$78K median (compiled from U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, Occupational Outlook Handbook ranges). The starting and top bars are modeled around that median — orientation, not a promise. Pay swings hard by state, employer and experience: check live postings in your state before planning around any number.

WHAT DOES A INSURANCE CLAIMS ADJUSTER ACTUALLY DO?

- ✓ Review claims and decide what the policy covers
- ✓ Inspect damage — photos, site visits, estimates
- ✓ Interview claimants and witnesses; check for fraud signals
- ✓ Negotiate settlements and authorize payments

Think: a referee for accidents — part detective, part estimator, part negotiator — except the instant-replay machine now makes the easy calls before you're assigned.

WHAT AI ALREADY TOOK (AND WHAT IT CAN'T)

THE ROBOT	THE HUMAN
Photo-estimating software evaluates damage images and calculates claim amounts (BLS's own example); AI intake captures first notice of loss, and straight-through processing closes simple claims end to end. Honest counterweight: industry-wide STP is still under 10% and ~60% of insurers have no claims STP at all — this is a hiring squeeze at the entry rung, not a vanishing act.	Complex liability, injury claims, fraud investigation, catastrophe field work and angry-human negotiation stay human. The problem: those are the senior seats. You reach them through the small-claims rung that's being automated first.

⚠ **Licensing is a patchwork: 34 states require an adjuster licence, 16 + DC don't license adjusters at all, and staff adjusters often work under the company licence. A licence you may not even need is not a moat — and Xactimate skill, the real employer expectation, is a tool certification anyone can buy.**

THE VIBE — IS THIS YOUR LIFE?

THE JOB IS	THE JOB IS NOT

✓ A real $78K median with a top decile over $117K ✓ Field work and investigation, not pure desk time ✓ Storm seasons bring catastrophe deployments and overtime money	✗ A shrinking occupation: −5%, with all openings replacement-only ✗ Your first assignment tier is the automation target ✗ You deliver 'no' and low numbers to people on their worst week

Good fit? You like investigation and negotiation and want insurance money — on the selling or risk side, where humans are the product.
Bad fit? You want the stable processing career the title used to mean; that version is what the −5% is measuring.

THE FORK — PICK ONE DOOR

DOOR A — PIVOT TO Commercial Insurance Producer	DOOR B — PIVOT TO Property Manager
The licensed selling side of the same industry: producers advise businesses on coverage, place policies and keep a book of business that renews — and renews — every year. The state producer licence is a real gate, and the work is relationships and risk judgment, the layer AI supports instead of replaces. Your claims eye is a genuine edge: nobody sells coverage like someone who has watched claims get denied. First move: complete your state's producer pre-licensing and interview agencies on their commercial books.	BLS median $69,990, growth +4%, ~36,900 openings a year. Adjusters spend their days on property damage, repair scopes and vendor estimates — which is the daily substance of managing buildings. The pivot trades a shrinking processing pool for an on-site job whose desk layer is automated around a human core: inspections, turnovers, disputes, emergencies. First move: apply to assistant manager or leasing roles at management firms and bring your damage-assessment experience.

Smart move: Sell the claim-side scar tissue: 'I've read a thousand ways buildings fail' is a pitch both agencies and property firms understand instantly.
Where you land after: You land where insurance knowledge compounds instead of expiring: a producer's renewing book, or a manager's portfolio of doors — both pay you for judgment about risk, not for processing it.

YOUR ROADMAP — 6 STEPS

1	2	3	4	5	6
READ THE	INVENTORY THE	PICK YOUR	START THE	APPLY WITH	BUILD THE

STEP 1 — Read the outlook line

FREE · TODAY

- Open the BLS claims page and find the sentence where technology and AI are named as the brake
- Note the split: −5% growth, ~21,600 openings, all replacement

STEP 2 — Inventory the transferable stack

WEEKS 1–2

- Damage assessment, policy reading, negotiation, fraud sense — list them with claim examples
- Drop 'processes small claims fast' from the pitch; that's the automated layer

STEP 3 — Pick your door

WEEK 2

- Door A stays in insurance: producer licence, selling side, renewing book
- Door B stays on property: management firms, salaried portfolio work

STEP 4 — Start the licence that gates something

WEEKS 2–8

- Producer route: complete your state's pre-licensing and sit the exam
- Manager route: map your state's PM licence rule — most route it through the broker licence

STEP 5 — Apply with the claims angle

WEEKS 4–10

- Agencies and firms both understand 'I've seen how losses happen'
- Bring two anonymized claim stories: what you spotted, what it saved

STEP 6 — Build the renewing asset

ONGOING

- A producer's book or a manager's portfolio pays monthly and annually
- Processing paid per file; assets pay while you sleep — that's the whole trade

FIRST 90 DAYS — JUST DO THIS

□ Today: read the BLS claims outlook paragraph out loud — the mechanism is printed, not rumored.

□ Days 1–30: stack inventoried; door chosen; producer or PM licence path started.

□ Days 31–60: licence coursework underway; applications out with the claims-angle pitch.

□ Days 61–90: interviews at agencies or management firms; licence exam scheduled.

□ Day 90: you're entering insurance through a door that grows — book or portfolio — not the rung being automated.

NEXT — MAKE IT PERSONAL

This roadmap is the same for everyone. Your life is not.

- Not sure this career fits YOU? Take the Big Career Test — 50 questions, your top-3 matches and one honest "probably NOT you". → careerglitch.com/#test
- Already sure? Turn AI into Your Personal Career Mentor — a 2,300-word system that interviews you first, checks your hours, budget and deadline honestly, and builds YOUR plan into a Notion dashboard. → careerglitch.com/#prompt

★ SELL THE POLICY. SKIP THE QUEUE. ★